

Segment 29 Road Between Lakes Arfelin & Big Bear to Lake Elinor Outlet

(Formerly Segment 26), Updated April 2024 [Google Map of Segment 29](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

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Segment length: About 2 miles, east to west 141 ft of ascent, 204 ft of descent

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) Use Map # 34 in the Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact mac@northcountrytrail.org or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (all trail descriptions will be westbound, follow in reverse for eastbound)

This segment begins at an easily accessed parking area at a T" intersection. (46.631734,-88.072643) After a short hike on a grassy two track, the trail cuts into the woods and meanders through mixed hardwoods, spruce, fir, and pine forests. With minor undulations, you will come out on the south shore of Big Bear Lake, with several nice viewing spots a few steps from the trail. The trail then comes back out on a well-traveled two track for over a mile before turning into the woods again. The segment ends at Marian's Bridge, at the outlet of Lake Elinor. (46.627707,-88.099883)

Driving Directions

Eastern Trailhead:

From Marquette, take US-41 west through Champion and past Van Riper State Park. Just after crossing the Peshekee River, turn right (north) on [County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./Huron Bay Grade]. This road is blacktopped but is very rough in spots, so drive slowly. Stay on [County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./Huron Bay Grade] for about 7.4 miles. (Be careful not to take Dishno Road to the right at about 4.1 miles.) Turn left onto the unnamed dirt road. There is a sign with a number of names at this intersection. Continue for about 1.5 miles and stay to the right. Continue about .7 miles and again bear right. In another .6 miles, bear right. Continue for about 1.1 miles to where the NCT crosses. Using the following Google Map is strongly recommended. [Driving map to parking for S28 & 29](#)

Western Trailhead:

The actual western trailhead is not reachable via vehicle. We recommend that you either leave your vehicle at the Avenza parking area at (46.627577,-88.084852) and walk the trail roughly one mile to the west end of the segment, or combine this short segment with an adjacent segment. Driving directions/map to this recommended parking are as follows. From Marquette, take US-41 west through Champion and past Van Riper State Park. Just after crossing the Peshekee River, turn right (north) on [County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./Huron Bay Grade]. This road is blacktopped but is very rough in spots, so drive slowly. Stay on [County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./Huron Bay Grade] for about 7.4 miles. (Be sure not to take Dishno Rd to the right at around mile 4.1.) Turn left onto the unnamed dirt road. There is a sign with a number of names at this intersection. Continue for about 1.5 miles and stay to the right. Continue about .7 miles and again bear right. In another .6 miles, turn left. Continue for about 1.2 miles to where the NCT crosses. Using the following Google Map is strongly recommended. [Driving map to parking east of Lake Elinor Outlet](#)

Camping:

There are lots of private landowners near the lakes- do not camp without permission. Away from the lakes it is primarily commercial forest, so camping is allowed, but be sure to verify land ownership. There are some good unestablished camping spots near Marian's Bridge.

Water Access:

Water is available along the west branch of the Peshekee River and at Big Bear Lake.

Seasonal Access Information:

From late spring through early winter a higher clearance vehicle is necessary to reach the parking areas- the roads are rough. Neither parking area is accessible via vehicle in the wintertime.